

vim editor cheatsheet

Insert Mode

i insert before the cursor
I insert at the beginning of the line
a insert (append) after the cursor
A insert (append) at the end of the line
o append (open) a new line below the current line
O append (open) a new line above the current line
ea insert (append) at the end of the word
Esc exit insert mode

Visual Mode

v start visual mode, mark lines, then do a command like y-yank
V start linewise visual mode
o move to other end of marked area
O move to other corner of block
aw mark a word
ab a block with ()
aB a block with {}
ib inner block with ()
iB inner block with {}
Esc exit visual mode
Ctrl + v start visual block mode

Working with files

:e file edit a file in a new buffer
:bnext go to the next buffer
:bprev go to the previous buffer
:bd delete a buffer (close a file)
:ls list all open buffers
Ctrl + ws split window
Ctrl + ww switch windows
Ctrl + wq quit a window
Ctrl + wv split window vertically
Ctrl + wh move cursor to the left window
Ctrl + wl move cursor to the right window
Ctrl + wj move cursor to the window below

Global and Exiting

:help keyword open help for keyword
:o file open file
:saveas file save file as
:close close current pane
:w write (save) the file, but don't exit
:w !sudo tee % write out the current file using sudo
:wq or :x or ZZ write (save) and quit
:q quit (fails if there are unsaved changes)
:q! or ZQ quit and throw away unsaved changes



yy yank (copy) a line
2yy yank (copy) 2 lines
y\$ yank (copy) to end of line
p put (paste) the clipboard after cursor
P put (paste) before cursor
dd delete (cut) a line
2dd delete (cut) 2 lines
dw delete (cut) a word
D delete (cut) to the end of the line
d\$ delete (cut) to the end of the line
dO delete (cut) to the beginning of the line
x delete (cut) character

r replace a single character
J join line below to the current one
cc change (replace) entire line
cw change (replace) to the start of the next word
ce change (replace) to the end of the next word
cb change (replace) to the start of the previous word
cO change (replace) to the start of the line
c\$ change (replace) to the end of the line
s delete character and substitute text
S delete line and substitute text (same as cc)
xp transpose two letters (delete and paste)
· repeat last command
u undo
Ctrl + r redo

/pattern search for pattern
?pattern search backward for pattern
\vpattern 'very magic' pattern: non-alphanumeric characters are interpreted as special regex symbols (no escaping needed)
n repeat search in same direction
N repeat search in opposite direction
:%s/old/new/g replace all old with new throughout file
:%s/old/new/gc replace all old with new throughout file with confirmations
:noh remove highlighting of search matches

:tabnew file open a file in a new tab
Ctrl + wT move the current split window into its own tab
:tabnext move to the next tab
:tabprev move to the previous tab
<num>gt move to tab <num>
:tabclose close the current tab and all its windows
:tabonly close all tabs except for the current one
:tabdo command run the command on all tabs (e.g. :tabdo q - closes all opened tabs)

Copy, Cut & Paste

Editing

Search & Replace

Tabs